HAIR LOSS 06

Biotin

A B vitamin, sold in dietary supplements including hair, skin and nail products



CLASS	STUDIED FOR	HUMAN EVIDENCE	US STATUS
Vitamin (dietary supplement)	Hair growth, hair quality	Small human studies	Dietary supplement

STUDIED FOR

Hair growth
HUMAN

Research is thin. In the best study, double-blind and placebo-controlled, hair growth did not differ between biotin and placebo.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Biotin ▶ B vitamin ▶ Hair follicle ▶ Hair growth

- Biotin is a **B vitamin** taken by mouth in supplements
- **In people,** a mechanism for hair loss is not established
- **Lab tests:** biotin can interfere with some blood tests, including troponin

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

SMALL HUMAN
LEVEL 3 OF 5

- A 2024 review found 3 studies
- Best study: no difference vs placebo
- 10-man crossover study in men without hair loss

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Effect on hair loss
- Mechanism for hair

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE	ROUTES STUDIED
Not established	By mouth
PHARMACOKINETICS	**SOLD AS**
Not established	Dietary supplement
MONITORED IN TRIALS	**SPORT (WADA)**
Hair growth speed, hair quality	Not on the 2026 list

REGULATORY

FDA	Dietary supplement; not approved for hair loss
FDA	Warns biotin can cause wrong lab test results
WADA	Not on the 2026 list

REFERENCES

1. Yelich et al., J Clin Aesthet Dermatol, oral biotin for hair (review), Aug 2024
2. FDA, Biotin interference with troponin lab tests, Jun 2022
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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